As a growing number of diners trade single malts for single-source water, the demand for sophisticated alternatives has skyrocketed. In response, water is being elevated with the same reverence once reserved for fine wines and vintage spirits, and I, for one, am a recent convert. I used to think water was just water, something to be gulped down between courses. That changed when I was handed a glass of Svalbarði. Harvested from 4,000-year-old icebergs, it was velvety, almost sweet, and remarkably light. In that moment, I realised that the liquid in my hand had as much personality, terroir, and history as the vintage Bordeaux sitting next to it. It is a realisation spreading across the globe. With the rise of sober-curious culture, water has shed its image as a mere utility. It is now being served with the same ceremony and price tag once reserved for rare spirits. High-end restaurants and luxury retreats are now moving beyond creative zero proof drinks to embrace fine waters from extraordinary origins like volcanoes, ancient springs, and polar icebergs. Technical specs like zero nitrate levels, Total Dissolved Solids (TDS), and pH balances have become the new indicators of status on the dining table.

